Amazon Q

What is Amazon Q?

Amazon Q is a generative AI assistant designed to transform how work gets done in organizations. It helps users with a variety of tasks, including software development, business intelligence, and customer service, by providing insights, automating tasks, and streamlining workflows. Amazon Q comes in two main versions: Amazon Q Business for general enterprise use and Amazon Q Developer specifically for software development on AWS.

Key features and capabilities of Amazon Q include:

1. **Generative AI:** Amazon Q leverages generative AI to understand natural language, generate code, summarize information, and automate tasks.
2. **Enterprise-focused:**Amazon Q Business is tailored to specific business needs, allowing users to find information, gain insights, and take action based on their company's data.
3. **Developer-focused:**Amazon Q Developer helps developers understand, build, extend, and operate applications and workloads on AWS, including code generation, testing, debugging, and troubleshooting.
4. **Integration with other tools:**Amazon Q integrates with popular applications like Slack, Microsoft 365, and web browsers, making it accessible in the tools users already use.
5. **Agentic capabilities:**Amazon Q can perform tasks on users' behalf, such as reading and writing files, generating code diffs, and running shell commands, with user feedback incorporated throughout the process.

Specific examples of how Amazon Q can be used:

- **Software Development:**Generating code, testing, debugging, and troubleshooting code, especially within the AWS environment.
- **Business Intelligence:**Analyzing data, generating reports, and identifying trends.
- **Customer Service:**Providing faster issue resolution, personalized responses, and recommended actions to customer service agents.
- **General Enterprise Use:**Finding information, answering questions, summarizing data, and completing tasks based on company knowledge and systems.

How to Install Amazon Q CLI on Windows (Step-by-Step Guide)

While Amazon Q CLI doesn't offer a native Windows installer yet, this guide will walk you through how to effortlessly install and run it on Windows using WSL (Windows Subsystem for Linux).

Prerequisites: Setting Up WSL on Windows

Before we dive into Amazon Q CLI, make sure WSL (Windows Subsystem for Linux) is installed and set up on your machine.

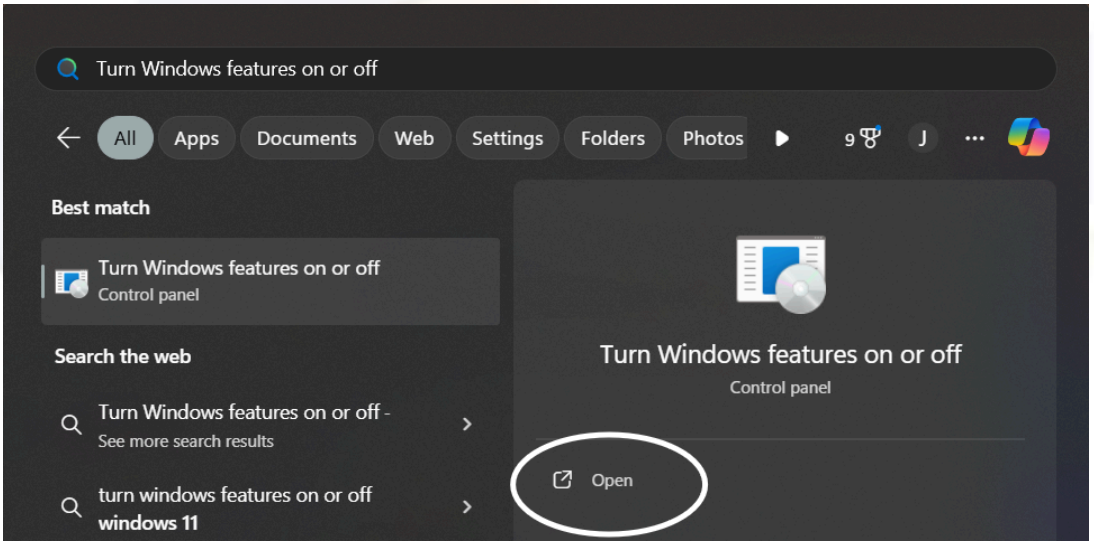
What is WSL?

WSL (Windows Subsystem for Linux) is a feature in Windows that lets you run a real Linux terminal right inside your Windows machine. You can use Linux commands, install tools, and even run code - just like on a real Ubuntu machine.

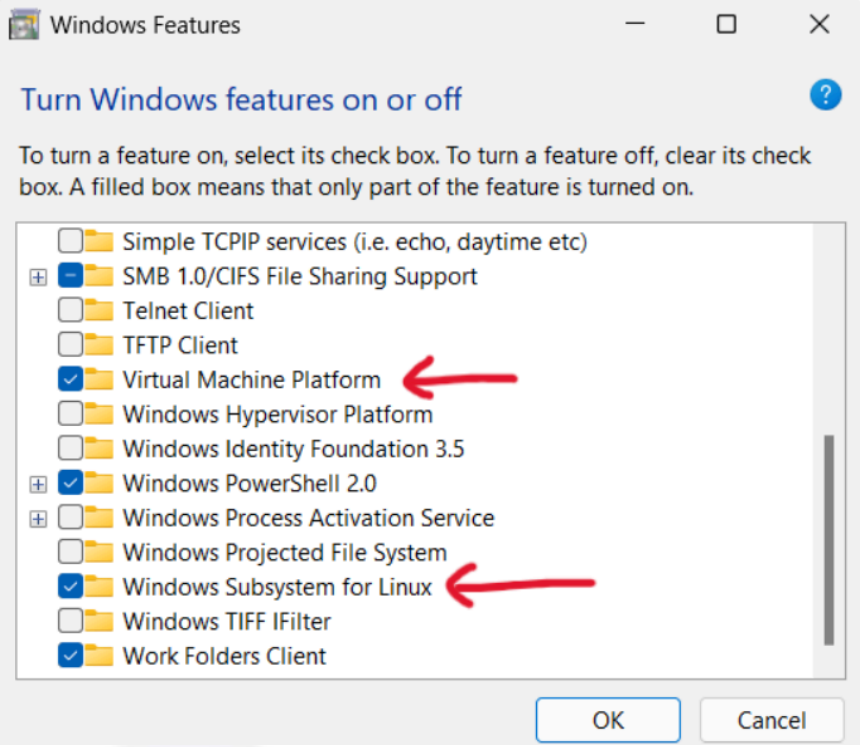
Install Ubuntu on Windows

Enable WSL on Your Windows

1. Click on the Start Menu and search for **"Turn Windows features on or off".**



2. Open the result. A new window will appear with a list of Windows features.
3. Scroll down and check the following two boxes:
   - Windows Subsystem for Linux
   - Virtual Machine Platform

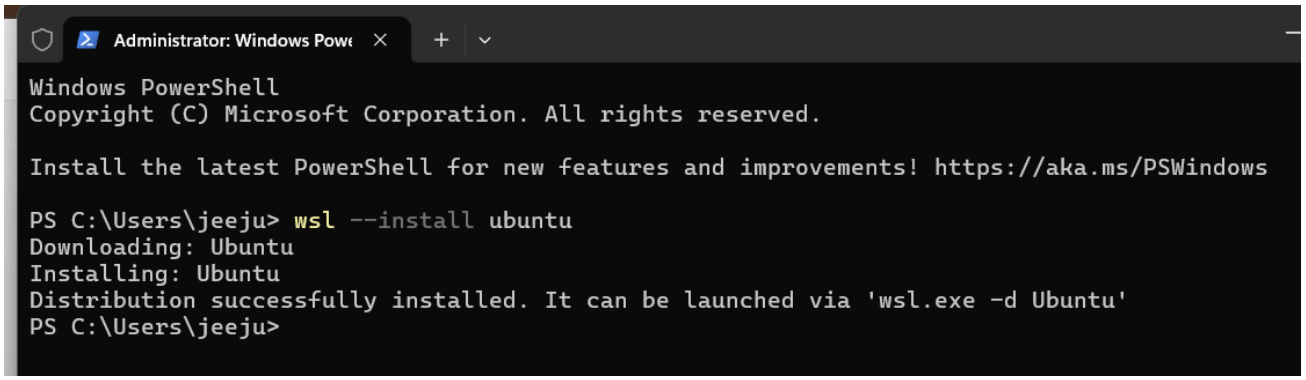


4. Click OK. Windows will apply the changes and may ask you to **restart your computer.**
5. After restarting, **WSL will be enabled on your system**

Install Ubuntu

- Now that WSL is enabled, installing Ubuntu on your Windows system is pending.
- Open the Start Menu and search "Command Prompt" or "PowerShell".
- Right-click and choose **"Run as administrator".**
- Enter the following command to install Ubuntu:

  wsl --install ubuntu



Once completed, restart your computer if prompted.

Once Ubuntu is installed, you can easily launch it from the command line.

Type the following command and press Enter:

wsl -d Ubuntu

- It will ask you to create a new username and password for Ubuntu. Set username and password.

```
avinash@JEEJULAROHAN: /m
PS C:\Users\jeeju> wsl --install ubuntu
Downloading: Ubuntu
Installing: Ubuntu
Distribution successfully installed. It can be launched via 'wsl.exe -d Ubuntu'
PS C:\Users\jeeju> wsl -d Ubuntu
Provisioning the new WSL instance Ubuntu
This might take a while...
Create a default Unix user account: avinash
New password:
Retype new password:
passwd: password updated successfully
To run a command as administrator (user "root"), use "sudo <command>".
See "man sudo_root" for details.

Welcome to Ubuntu 24.04.3 LTS (GNU/Linux 5.15.167.4-microsoft-standard-WSL2 x86_64)

 * Documentation:  https://help.ubuntu.com
 * Management:     https://landscape.canonical.com
 * Support:        https://ubuntu.com/pro

 System information as of Wed Aug 20 07:30:34 UTC 2025

  System load:  0.0                 Processes:             31
  Usage of /:   0.1% of 1006.85GB   Users logged in:       0
  Memory usage: 3%                  IPv4 address for eth0: 172.18.165.151
  Swap usage:   0%

This message is shown once a day. To disable it please create the
/home/avinash/.hushlogin file.
avinash@JEEJULAROHAN:/mnt/c/Users/jeeju$
```

You now have Ubuntu running on your Windows machine.

Once you have WSL installed and a Linux distribution like Ubuntu set up, you're ready to go!

STEP 1: Sign Up for Your AWS Builder ID

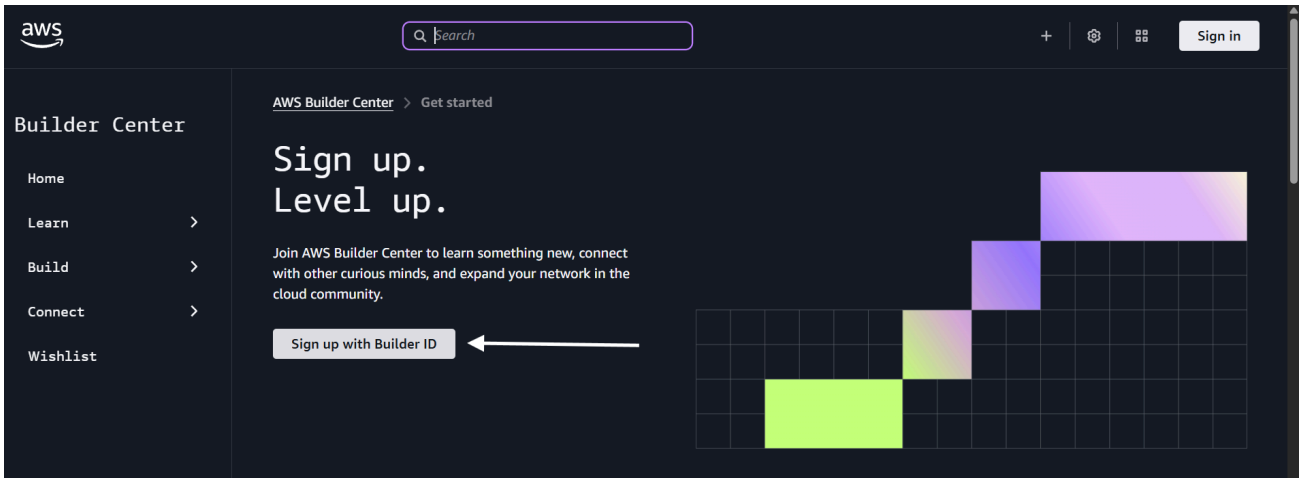
Before anything else, you'll need an AWS Builder ID to access Amazon Q CLI and claim your personalised developer handle on community.aws.

Sign up and claim your username here

After signing up:

- Save your login details
- Note your community.aws username

- You're now officially part of the AWS developer community!



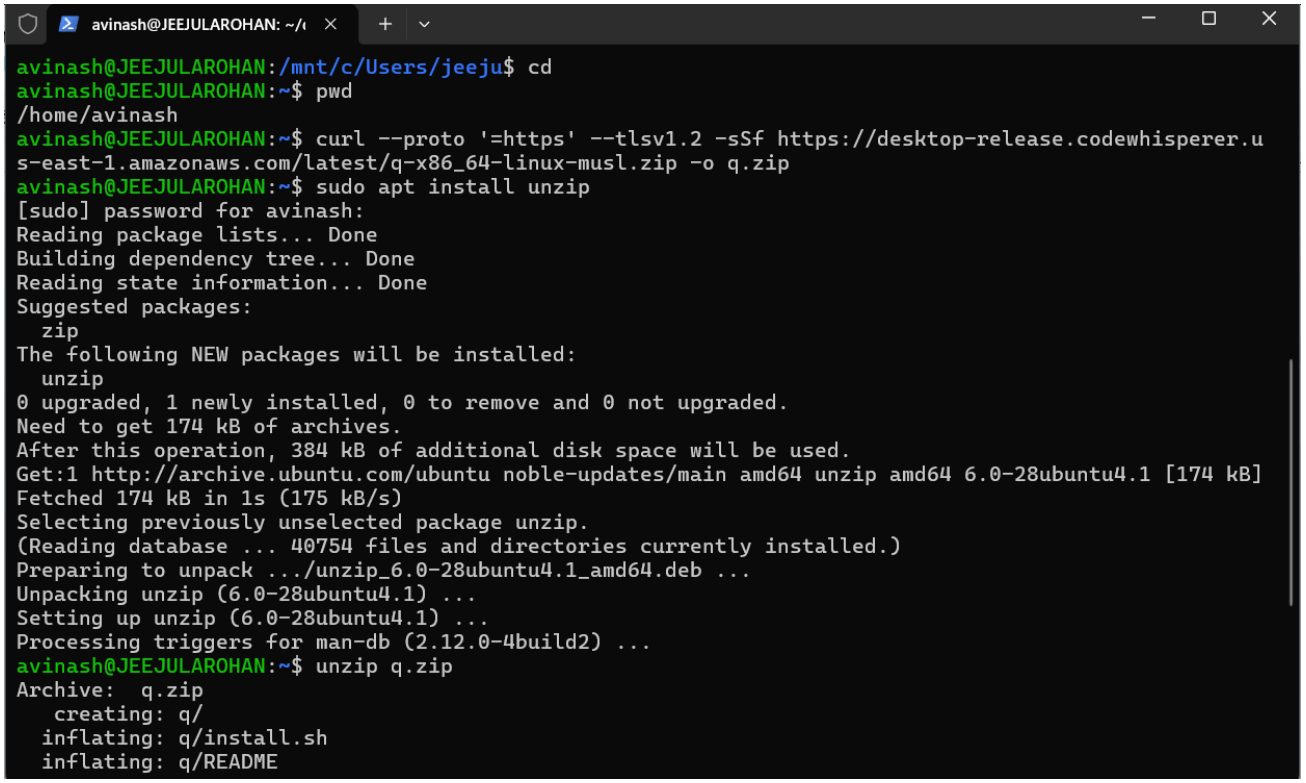
Go to Your Ubuntu Home Directory

cd

pwd # Should return something like /home/your-username

Download the Amazon Q CLI Installer

curl --proto '=https' --tlsv1.2 -sSf https://desktop-release.codewhisperer.us-east-1.amazonaws.com/latest/q-x86_64-linux-musl.zip -o q.zip. This package is installed in q.zip



Install Required Package
sudo apt install unzip
This installs the unzip utility required for the next step.
Now, It will ask for the password that you have created during the setup of Ubuntu. Just type that password and hit Enter.
Unzip the Installer
unzip q.zip

```
avinash@JEEJULAROHAN: ~/(
Fetched 174 kB in 1s (175 kB/s)
Selecting previously unselected package unzip.
(Reading database ... 40754 files and directories currently installed.)
Preparing to unpack .../unzip_6.0-28ubuntu4.1_amd64.deb ...
Unpacking unzip (6.0-28ubuntu4.1) ...
Setting up unzip (6.0-28ubuntu4.1) ...
Processing triggers for man-db (2.12.0-4build2) ...
avinash@JEEJULAROHAN:~$ unzip q.zip
Archive:  q.zip
   creating: q/
  inflating: q/install.sh
  inflating: q/README
  inflating: q/BUILD-INFO
   creating: q/bin/
  inflating: q/bin/q
  inflating: q/bin/qterm
  inflating: q/bin/qchat
avinash@JEEJULAROHAN:~$ cd q
chmod +x install.sh
./install.sh
✔Do you want q to modify your shell config (you will have to manually do this otherwise)? · Yes
✔Select login method · Use for Free with Builder ID

Confirm the following code in the browser
Code: MCLR-WXBX

Open this URL: https://view.awsapps.com/start/#/device?user_code=MCLR-WXBX
Device authorized
Logged in successfully
avinash@JEEJULAROHAN:~/q$
```

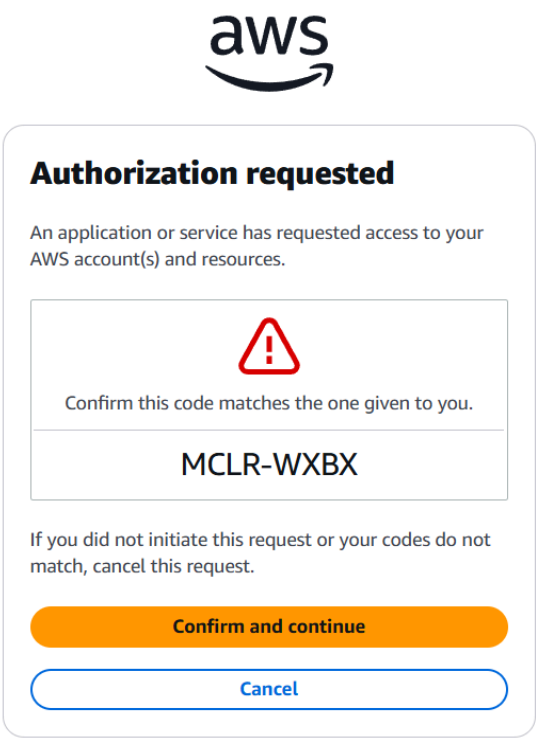
Make Installer Executable & Install

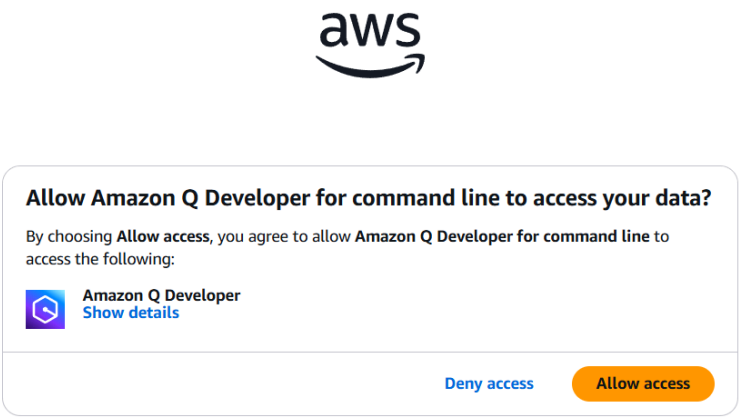
cd q
chmod +x install.sh
./install.sh

Answer "Yes" when asked to modify your shell config.
Select: "Use for Free with Builder ID"

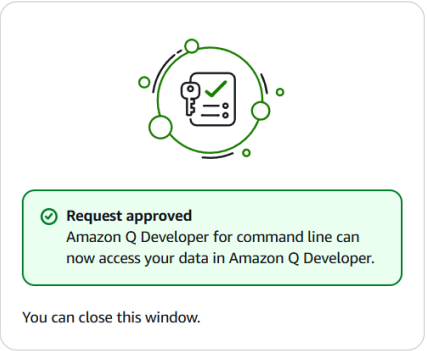
Now You'll be given a URL. Open it in your browser, log in, and you're authenticated!

Check the following outputs -





Amazon Q CLI is now installed on your Windows machine via WSL!

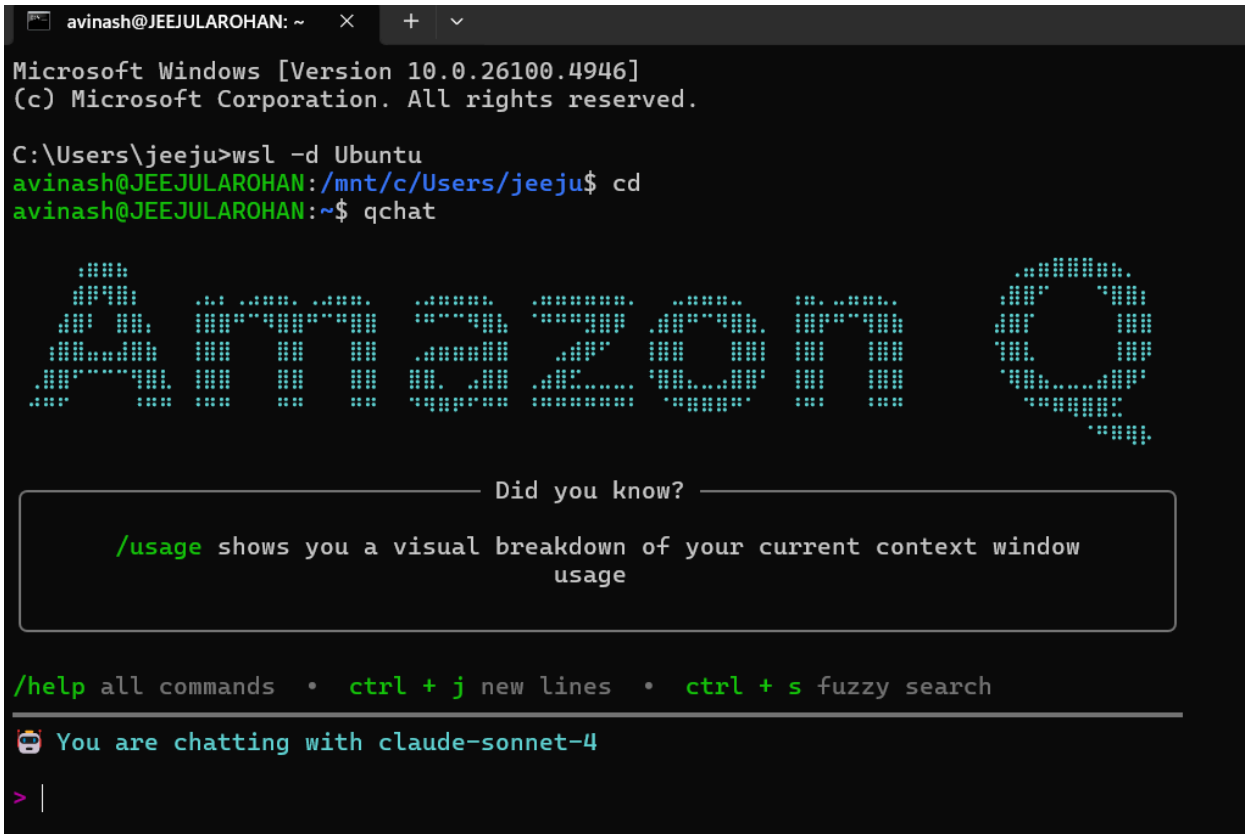


STEP 2: Start Chatting with Amazon Q

To begin chatting with Amazon Q:

Simply close your current terminal window.

Reopen the terminal and launch Ubuntu using: **wsl -d Ubuntu.**



You're now ready to interact with Amazon Q right from your terminal!.

Start a chat session with Amazon Q CLI as per your needs.

To exit the chat, type: /q.

To leave WSL, type: exit